Oghatharana Mārgaya 03

The Path to Crossing the Torrent

Oghatharana Mārgaya 03

(The Path of Crossing the Torrent)

A Gift of Dhamma,
dedicated to the faithful ones
who strive for liberation
from the suffering of Saṃsāra

By Venerable Kolombugama Dhammadeepa Thero

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- Arriving At the Noble Eightfold Path through Anapanasati Meditation
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Sharing of Merit

May the power of merit generated by this gift of Dhamma be a causing resource for the realization of the Supreme Peace of Nibbana for our honorable teacher, Most Venerable Asgiriwalpola Sudassi Maha Thero, who guided and advised us from the very beginning to prepare this book;
for all the Kalyanamitta venerables and devotees who assisted in various ways!

Oghatharaṇa Mārgaya

The Path to Crossing the Torrent

To realize the Four Noble Truths,

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The Noble Eightfold Path must be reached

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The Seven Factors of Enlightenment must be developed

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The Five Spiritual Powers must be developed

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The Five Spiritual Faculties must be developed

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The Four Bases of Spiritual Power must be developed

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The Fourfold Right Efforts must be developed

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The Four Foundations of Mindfulness must be developed

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The necessity to be liberated from the suffering of Samsara must be arisen

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The fear regarding Samsara must be arisen

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The phenomena of birth, old-age, sickness and death must be investigated

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Mundane Right View must be present

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Unwholesome signs and wholesome signs must be identified

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Unwholesome roots and wholesome roots must be identified

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Unwholesomeness and wholesomeness must be identified

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The True Dhamma must be listened

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Good Spiritual friends must be met

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Prior merit must be present

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- Identifying Unwholesome Signs and Wholesome Signs

Namo Tassa Bhagavato Arahato Samma Sambuddhassa!
Namo Tassa Bhagavato Arahato Samma Sambuddhassa!
Namo Tassa Bhagavato Arahato Samma Sambuddhassa!

I pay homage to that Fortunate, Worthy, Perfectly Self-Enlightened One! May my homage be offered!

So, today is the tenth sermon of this series

Devotees, endowed with faith and wisdom, who are listening to the Dhamma through this Oghatharana Daham Sangrahaya YouTube Channel, you are preparing today to join us with yet another Dhamma sermon. Everyone is preparing today to connect with the tenth sermon conducted by us.

Our goal is the seeing of these Four Noble Truths

So, devotees, by now, we have preached to you through nine programs regarding the way of practicing and training many Dhamma matters in daily life. We started this sermon series by introducing it, and after that, we mentioned to you the arrangement of this sermon series. We have arranged this sermon series for the purpose of seeing the Four Noble Truths within this life, within this Buddha Sasana. It is based on the matters of how we should be disciplined in order within this Dhamma. Then, our goal is the seeing of these Four Noble Truths.

So, there we mentioned that if one is to see the Four Noble Truths, one must come to the Noble Eightfold Path. Therefore, we must travel toward this Noble Eightfold Path systematically. How to practice this Dhamma in

our lives systematically until the point of reaching that Noble Eightfold Path? How to train? This is what is presented to you to the best of our strength.

Today, we are preparing to start the sermon related to the topic: Identifying Unwholesome Signs and Wholesome Signs

At this point, we mentioned to you that, conditioned by past merit, one meets good spiritual friends (kalyana-mitta). We mentioned that after meeting good spiritual friends conditioned by past merit, one gets to hear the True Dhamma from those good spiritual friends. Conditioned by hearing that True Dhamma, we mentioned to you that one can identify the wholesomeness and the unwholesomeness. Conditioned by identifying the wholesomeness and the unwholesomeness, we mentioned that one can identify the wholesome roots and the unwholesome roots. We concluded the last program by mentioning to you that, conditioned by identifying wholesome roots and unwholesome roots, the act of identifying unwholesome signs and wholesome signs takes place.

In the second sermon conducted regarding identifying wholesome roots and unwholesome roots, we mentioned the identifying of bodily actions, verbal actions, and mental actions performed based on those unwholesome roots and wholesome roots. Then, up to the point of identifying these bodily actions, verbal actions, and mental actions—namely, unwholesome bodily, verbal, and mental actions and wholesome bodily, verbal, and mental actions—we have finished preaching the Dhamma to these devotees in order by now. Today, we are preparing to start the sermon related to the topic of identifying unwholesome signs and wholesome signs.

The Dhamma must be practiced and trained as the beginning, the middle, and the end

So, devotees, this sermon at the point of identifying unwholesome signs and wholesome signs is not a place where we can move forward very rapidly like previous sermons. Here, we expect to preach to you regarding the restraint of the sense faculties (indriya-samvara). Likewise, we expect to teach you here how to practice and train eight, nine, or a close number of the ten recollection meditations. Therefore, in this way, we expect to conduct about 10 or 12 sermons forward by explaining this topic in detail. Because of that, I remind you here that while listening to this Dhamma by giving it extreme value and importance, you should act and think to practice and train this Dhamma systematically.

Now, in this journey you have come through this Dhamma listening, we said from the very beginning, didn't we, to identify that you have past merit? We told you to reflect on that, didn't we? Likewise, we reminded you of the factors necessary to identify that past merit exists. Have those been received? They have been received; we told you to think, ponder, and reflect on that. Likewise, one must listen to the Dhamma; in this Dhamma, the beginning, the middle, and the end have been well preached. You should listen to that Dhamma well in its beginning, middle, and end, and we mentioned that you should practice and train that Dhamma you hear as the beginning, the middle, and the end.

Who is a good spiritual friend?

After that, we mentioned to you: who is a good spiritual friend? How to identify a good spiritual friend? Why should a good spiritual friend be identified? Then, having identified those matters and by finding those good spiritual friends, we mentioned that the journey toward that Noble Eightfold Path happens very quickly within a short time. Likewise, we

mentioned to you that by identifying that good spiritual friend and listening to the Dhamma from the good spiritual friend, one becomes able to identify the unwholesomeness and the wholesomeness.

You have the ability, the skill, to identify these Dhamma natures

So, in this way, regarding the life of someone who has realized the Dhamma within this Buddha Sasana, regarding the life of someone who is realizing the Dhamma, and likewise, within this fourfold assembly of monks, nuns, devout men, and women who have gone to the refuge of the Triple Gem saying **Buddhaṃ saraṇaṃ gacchāmi, Dhammaṃ saraṇaṃ gacchāmi, Saṅghaṃ saraṇaṃ gacchāmi**—devotees, we must identify in our lives the nature of identifying the Dhamma and behaving and acting in accordance with the Dhamma. Then, we will have gained what we should get, what we must obtain, from this Buddha Sasana.

That Nibbana, peace, liberation, and happiness—all of this we receive within this Buddha Sasana after we start to listen to this Dhamma in order, investigate with wisdom, and think, ponder, act, and implement accordingly. Therefore, when thinking and pondering like this, you will feel a great ease and lightness in your life, as well as a good understanding of yourself. Likewise, you will be able to identify and see that many of your very large changes, as well as many flaws, have been corrected and are being corrected. Also, you see that there are wrong flaws within yourself. You see that wrong flaws are being corrected. You will begin to understand how you should act in the future by further fixing and correcting these wrong flaws. So, that is "living by making the Dhamma a mirror" within this Dhamma—you should apply that simile, then think, ponder, and act upon it.

Therefore, devotees, also when listening to this Dhamma, you will realize that you have the ability, the skill, to identify these Dhamma natures. Look, what we said at the beginning—you have gathered and prepared the ability

to realize Nibbana, the skill to realize Nibbana, conditioned by past merit. But you must bring out and develop that skill by listening to the Dhamma in this way and by identifying these Dhamma natures one by one.

We do not know that we can draw pictures. Therefore, we are not yet a person who draws pictures. We haven't even thought about starting it. Because we think we don't have that ability. Therefore, there isn't even an effort to learn it. We don't even incline the mind. we don't know that such an ability exists. But while doodling on a piece of paper with a pencil during a free moment, we identify: "I can draw, can't I?" After that, devotees, we start to search for it. We start to talk about it. we start to practice and train more and more. After some days pass, one becomes an artist that the world talks about. After we start doing that thing, that ability—just like the sun appearing in the sky and coming to illuminate the whole world—comes out from within us and becomes one who holds a lamp in hand, spreading light to the whole world.

This Dhamma is wonderfully peaceful and sublime

In the same way, when hearing this Dhamma and making an effort to see this Dhamma within oneself, then, to what level have the sense faculties (indriya-dhamma) necessary to see that Dhamma grown within you? To what extent can those skills be further developed? Is it possible? One sees those matters as well as the fact that Nibbana can be realized within this life, begins to be realized within oneself. Also, how much further is it to reach that place of realizing Nibbana, the Noble Eightfold Path? What are the obstacles and troubles to reaching that path? One sees this within oneself. Also, one understands the way to remove the troubles and obstacles that make it impossible to arriving that path. One understands the time required for that. The mindfulness and wisdom arise within oneself, devotees, that "to hasten that time, there is only the further practicing and training of this Dhamma in this manner."

So, devotees, such a nature should now have been prepared within you, who have become Buddhists, along with the Dhamma. Therefore, such a determination, such an effort, and such an investigation should be prepared within you. Also, you should have a mindfulness and wisdom within you: "I must change. When these and these flaws and errors of mine are pointed out within the Dhamma—yes, they exist. They must be identified. Having identified them, I must change"—that mindfulness and wisdom should be within you by now. Then look, even as we identify the unwholesome and the wholesome based on that association with good spiritual friends, devotees, I taught you how to identify the unwholesome and how to identify the wholesome. Even as you identify the unwholesome within you, the mindfulness, wisdom, necessity, desire, and determination arise within you that "this unwholesome must be ended, this unwholesome must be discarded."

Likewise, at the very point of identifying the wholesome, there arises within you the desire, determination, effort, and investigation that "this wholesome must be maintained again and again within this mind-stream." Therefore, devotees, through identifying these, what arises within you is not the desire to move away from the Dhamma again and again, but the need and desire that "I must dwell within this Dhamma." Devotees, the reason for that is that this Dhamma is wonderfully peaceful and sublime. Dwelling within the Dhamma is peaceful and sublime. It is endowed with happiness, devotees. Therefore, for as long as we do not identify it, we do not expect to hear, investigate, think, ponder, behave, and dwell in accordance with this Dhamma. That wisdom does not arise.

So, now we mentioned in previous sermons how to identify the wholesomeness and how to identify the unwholesomeness. Then, if you identified the wholesomeness in that way and identified the unwholesomeness, you become someone who constantly inclines the mind to

identify the wholesomeness and identify the unwholesomeness in that way—"I must identify this wholesomeness, I must identify this unwholesomeness."

Little by little, like a lamp, like a flower, life becomes illuminated. It becomes beautiful

Because you inclined the mind to identify the wholesomeness and the unwholesomeness in that way, through the **Opanayika** quality of this Dhamma as we mentioned before, the next and next Dhamma natures begin to be understood.

Even as you identify the unwholesomeness in that way, you get to see the unwholesome roots.
Even as you identify the wholesomeness in that way, you get to see the wholesome roots.
Look, until this time you had come to the point of identifying the wholesomeness and the unwholesomeness, but even having identified that wholesomeness and unwholesomeness, there was no ability to see those wholesome roots and unwholesome roots next.

Now, having identified that wholesomeness and unwholesomeness, based on the inclining of the mind to see that wholesomeness and unwholesomeness again and again, with the mindfulness that was born, with the stillness, and with the wisdom of the mind, by taking a step forward from there, the proficiency, ability, and skill to identify those wholesome roots and unwholesome roots arises within you. Now look, step by step, day by day, moment by moment, minute by minute, hour by hour, devotees, week by week, month by month, year by year—that skill that arose within you is developing, and you become one who travels forward and forward, dwelling within this Dhamma. So devotees, at the point where that wholesomeness and unwholesomeness were identified, that unwholesomeness which

oppressed us and existed for suffering is discarded from our mind-stream. Then, devotees, next, through your identifying of those unwholesome roots and wholesome roots, the unwholesome roots that were an oppression to us for so long begin to be discarded from our mind-stream. Likewise, through your identifying of unwholesome bodily, verbal, and mental actions, those unwholesome bodily, verbal, and mental actions settle down.

Likewise, through the identifying of wholesome bodily, verbal, and mental actions, you gain the ability to maintain those wholesome bodily, verbal, and mental actions continuously. So then, in a wonderful way within this Dhamma, your mind is tamed. The body is tamed. Speech is tamed. Otherwise, the mind is restrained. The body is restrained. Speech is restrained. Little by little, little by little, like a lamp, like a flower, life becomes illuminated. It becomes beautiful. Now you become able to see that fact within yourself. "A person who has settled down, a person who has cooled down, a person who is peaceful"—that is how people in society see you. Before the people in society, you see that nature. "Within my own mind, there is a certain peacefulness; in speech, a certain peacefulness; and likewise, in bodily actions, a certain peacefulness." Based on that existing peacefulness, a pleasant feeling endowed with renunciation (nekkhamma) begins to arise in your mind and body. Also, devotees, that previous lack of peace is removed, and the oppression that was within it begins to be discarded from you physically and mentally. Therefore, those who hear this Dhamma are persons who live within a very easy, comfortable dwelling.

Because of the very lack of practicing the Dhamma, day by day one does not become someone who solves problems

Many sufferings and difficulties, troubles and obstacles, arrive in their lives. Even though they arrive, such a person is not shaken within them. They do not grieve. There is no fear or trembling regarding the troubles and obstacles that are yet to arrive. Why? Now, within him, the

mindfulness, concentration, and wisdom of the mind have well developed. There is mindfulness. There is wisdom. By using that mindfulness and wisdom, an ability and skill to overcome the troubles and obstacles that have arrived and the troubles and obstacles yet to arrive is built through this Dhamma.

Otherwise, devotees, when a problem came, we only collapsed, cried, lamented, and grieved every day of our lives. The mindfulness, wisdom, and effort necessary to overcome them did not arise within us. We did not understand how to choose strategies. Likewise, through our acting without identifying wholesomeness and unwholesomeness like this, the problems in our lives only increase more and more; the problems do not decrease.

Because of the very lack of hearing the Dhamma and practicing the Dhamma like this, one is not someone who solves problems day by day, but someone who collects problems. Therefore, devotees, if you are practicing this Dhamma in this way by now, if you identified the unwholesomeness, if you identified the unwholesome roots, if you identified unwholesome bodily, verbal, and mental actions—the mindfulness and wisdom necessary not to maintain them, but to remove them, has arisen within you by now through that very identifying.

The Lord Buddha preached to us to win this world and to win the next world

Likewise, if you identified the wholesomeness, if you identified the wholesome roots, if you identified wholesome bodily, verbal, and mental actions—the ability, mindfulness, and wisdom to maintain them has arisen within you. Therefore, devotees, now look, the mental nature of a person who is going to realize Nibbana, the physical nature of a person who is going to realize Nibbana, the nature of the words of a person who is going to realize Nibbana—this is how it is described. Devotees, those natures are

what have started to arise within you in this way. Therefore, those coarser and coarser, unwholesome natures are removed, and a life, a physical and mental nature and state, that should bring in very sublime, subtle, wholesome natures begins to grow in this way.

Therefore, devotees, it is such a group of people that we expect to see from the devotees who listen to this Dhamma. It is not for anything else—the Lord Buddha preached to us a way to live happily, easily, joyfully, and peacefully within this Dhamma. The Lord Buddha showed it to us. The Lord Buddha taught us for forty-five years to live in this way.

So, if someone lives by turning their back on the Dhamma without practicing this Dhamma in this way, we see that he is a loser in this world and a loser in the next world. Therefore, we do not like to see someone who has lost this world and has fallen into suffering, oppression, and weariness. Devotees, we like to see someone who is happy in this world, who is not oppressed, who has won, who has succeeded. Someone who wins the next world, someone who succeeds in the next world. Therefore, the Lord Buddha preached this Dhamma truly for us to win this world and win the next world. So, when practicing and training that Dhamma in that way, day by day, we find you winning; we do not find you losing. We see that you will definitely win the next world as well. So, when practicing and training this Dhamma, that confidence arises within oneself from within oneself.

Today's topic is identifying unwholesome signs and wholesome signs

Then, therefore devotees, today's topic we have to talk about is identifying these unwholesome signs and wholesome signs.

Identifying Unwholesome Signs

Then, you have now identified the unwholesome, and I told you to label that "this is unwholesomeness." I told you to label and direct the mind. Likewise, I told you to establish mindfulness. After that, having identified the unwholesome roots, I told you to identify that "this is greed, this is hatred, this is delusion" as unwholesome roots, and to direct the mind and establish mindfulness.

Likewise, having identified and at the moment of establishing mindfulness, I told you to identify the bodily action that takes place with this unwholesome as its root—"this is an unwholesome bodily action." I told you to identify it, direct the mind, and establish mindfulness. Likewise, I told you to identify unwholesome verbal actions as "unwholesome verbal actions" and establish mindfulness. Likewise, I told you to label on unwholesome mental actions as "unwholesome mental actions" and establish mindfulness.

Devotees, even as you label in that way, as you establish mindfulness while labeling on the unwholesomeness, you can see the unwholesomeness gradually, gradually settling down. Devotees, this is a mindfulness and wisdom that has now arisen within you. You can see the way this unwholesomeness settles down. Not only that, you can also see the way the unwholesomeness grows through acting without directing the mind and establishing mindfulness toward the unwholesomeness in this way. By now, you are able to identify within yourself the way the unwholesomeness settles down and the way the unwholesomeness grows in that way.

Likewise, as you act further, you will be able to identify the way the greed, hatred, and delusion that arose in your mind settle down. You will also gain the ability to identify the way greed, hatred, and delusion grow. It is the same way, devotees; for as long as you do not identify them, unwholesome bodily, verbal, and mental actions will only be practiced day by day in your

life; they will not be removed. Likewise, as you identify them more and more, you can identify how unwholesome bodily, verbal, and mental actions gradually, gradually settle down. Then, just like the way a fire spreads and the way a fire is extinguished, it will be seen by you.

By now, these devotees are able to see and identify the way this unwholesomeness, the unwholesome roots, and unwholesome bodily, verbal, and mental actions grow and settle down. So then, devotees, in that way, as this unwholesomeness, the unwholesome roots, and unwholesome bodily, verbal, and mental actions settle down and settle down—next, you become able to identify within your mind-stream the unwholesome sign which was the condition for this unwholesomeness, the condition for the unwholesome roots, and the condition for the unwholesome bodily, verbal, and mental actions.

That unwholesome sign existing within your mind, could be a certain perception of a person, a sign of a person. Otherwise, it could be a sign, a perception, regarding some other external thing. When saying it is a perception of a being or a person, a sign of a person, that unwholesome sign is: when we think or contemplate with a mind associated with greed, hatred, and delusion (lobha, dvesha, moha) regarding people such as one's neighbors, brothers and sisters, teachers, relatives, and friends—the perception of that person which becomes the basis for that is the unwholesome sign there. Even regarding animals, when thinking or contemplating in this way with a mind of greed, hatred, and delusion, the perception of that being which is the root for that is the unwholesome sign there. Regarding things like weapons, cigarettes, or drugs, when we think or contemplate with a mind associated with greed, hatred, and delusion, the perception of the person or object which is the basis for that is the unwholesome sign there. Identifying these signs, devotees, is identifying unwholesome signs. So, we do not intend to give a lot of details about this here. However, this is the special topic we are talking about. Because, without you well-identifying

perceptions of persons and such unwholesome perceptions in this way, and understanding them as unwholesome signs and abandoning them, it is difficult to move forward.

Devotees, then regarding that, next, this relevant unwholesome sign begins to become manifest. Now, then, when your mindfulness is established by identifying those unwholesome roots and unwholesome bodily actions and so on, as those things gradually subside, now this unwholesome sign begins to be perceived clearly. Devotees, the unwholesome sign that was the root for that unwholesome act, that was the condition for that unwholesome act, that was the root for the unwholesome root, that was the condition for the unwholesome root, that was the root and condition for the unwholesome bodily action, verbal action, and mental action—behold, now at this moment, you must identify this unwholesome sign as "an unwholesome sign", direct your mind to that relevant unwholesome sign, and establish mindfulness; you must abandon it while labeling on this unwholesome sign as "an unwholesome sign".

Identifying Wholesome Signs

Then, next, let us talk about identifying wholesome signs. I told you to identify the wholesome and label, "this is wholesomeness." I told you to label and direct the mind. Also, I told you to establish mindfulness. After that, I told you to identify the wholesome roots, and as those wholesome roots are wholesome roots, to identify "this is non-greed, this is non-hatred, this is non-delusion," and direct the mind and establish mindfulness.

Also, while identifying and establishing mindfulness in that way, I told you to identify the bodily action that happens rooted in this wholesomeness as "this is a wholesome bodily action." I told you to identify and direct the mind and establish mindfulness. Also, I told you to identify wholesome verbal actions as "wholesome verbal actions" and establish mindfulness.

Also, I told you to label on wholesome mental actions as “wholesome mental actions” and establish mindfulness.

Devotees, when labeling like that, as mindfulness is established while labeling on the wholesomeness, you can see the wholesomeness gradually growing and persisting. Devotees, this is a mindfulness, a wisdom, that has now arisen within you. You can see the manner in which this wholesomeness grows and persists. Not only that, you can also see the manner in which the unwholesomeness grows through acting without directing the mind to the wholesomeness and establishing mindfulness in this way. By this time, you yourself are able to identify within you the manner in which the unwholesomeness subsides and the manner in which the wholesomeness grows in that way.

Also, as you continue to act in this way further, you will be able to identify the manner in which the non-greed, non-hatred, and non-delusion that arose in your mind grow and persist. You will get the ability to identify the manner in which non-greed, non-hatred, and non-delusion grow, again and again, continuously. It is the same way, devotees, for as long as you do not identify like that, there is no way for wholesome bodily actions, verbal actions, and mental actions to be practiced day by day in your life. They will not be practiced. Also, as you identify them more and more, wholesome bodily actions, verbal actions, and mental actions further become restrained little by little. They become pure. They become correct. It makes one feel like watching with joy. A great lightness, a solace, a comfort is felt. Then, you can identify it in that manner. Then, like the way a fire spreads and the way a fire is extinguished, you will get to see it.

These devotees are able to see and identify by this time the manner in which this wholesomeness, the wholesome roots, and wholesome bodily, verbal, and mental actions grow and persist. So, then, in that way, when this wholesomeness, wholesome roots, and wholesome bodily, verbal, and mental

actions grow and persist, devotees, next you will be able to identify within your mind-stream the wholesome sign which was the condition for this wholesomeness, the condition for the wholesome roots, and the condition for the wholesome bodily, verbal, and mental actions.

That wholesome sign could be a certain perception of a person, a sign of a person, existing within your mind. Otherwise, it could be a sign, a perception, regarding some other external thing. When saying it is a perception of a being or a person, a sign of a person, the wholesome sign is: the Buddha-perception called The Fortunate Lord Buddha, the perception of oneself—those who practice Loving-Kindness meditation know this. Also, regarding people such as mother, father, brothers, sisters, teachers, relatives, and friends, when we think or contemplate with a mind associated with non-greed, non-hatred, and non-delusion—the perception of the person which is the basis for that is the wholesome sign there. Even regarding animals, when thinking or contemplating in this way with a mind of non-greed, non-hatred, and non-delusion, the perception of the being which is the root for that is the wholesome sign there.

Also, if explaining further in this way: Bodhi trees, Bodhi-terraces and when offering things like oil, flowers, lamps, robes, requisites, food and drink, and medicines, when thinking and contemplating with a mind of non-greed, non-hatred, and non-delusion along with those signs and features, all those signs and features there are the wholesome sign. These, where we meditate on the Four Foundations of Mindfulness, change as the perception of mindfulness of breathing (ānāpānasati-saññā), the perception of foulness (asubha-saññā), the perception of the skeleton (aṭṭhika-saññā), the perception of earth (paṭhavi-saññā), and so on. As meditation grows further, they are identified as the perception of impermanence (anicca-saññā) and so on. In the Girimananda Sutta, the ten perceptions are described deeply and at length. This, devotees, is the identification of wholesome signs. So, we do not intend to give a lot of details about this here. However, this is

the special topic we are talking about. Because, without you well-identifying perceptions of persons in this way here, and practicing them as wholesome signs, it is difficult to move forward.

Devotees, then in this way regarding this, next, this relevant wholesome sign begins to become manifest. Now, then, when your mindfulness is established by identifying those wholesome roots and wholesome bodily actions and so on, now this wholesome sign begins to be perceived clearly. Devotees, the wholesome sign that was the root for that wholesomeness, that was the condition for that wholesomeness, that was the root for the wholesome root, that was the condition for the wholesome root, that was the root and condition for the wholesome bodily action, verbal action, and mental action—behold, now at this moment, you must identify this wholesome sign as "a wholesome sign", direct your mind to that relevant wholesome sign, and establish mindfulness; you must maintain it while labeling on this wholesome sign as "a wholesome sign" and establishing mindfulness.

At the moment of death, one of three things—Kamma (intentional action), Kamma-nimitta (sign of kamma), or Gati-nimitta (sign of destination) —becomes the object for that decease-consciousness (cuti-citta)

Now next, devotees, you identified the wholesomeness. You identified the wholesome roots. Also, act by identifying those wholesome bodily actions, verbal actions, and mental actions. Within that, to the mindfulness and wisdom that grows, you can identify the wholesome sign that is the root for it in that manner. Seeing that wholesome sign as "a wholesome sign", you direct the mind to that wholesome sign and establish mindfulness, labeling on that "wholesome sign".

Then, you see in that manner that relevant unwholesome sign as “an unwholesome sign”, and the wholesome sign as “a wholesome sign”. Now then, devotees, you realize that within your mind-stream in your life up to now, what you have collected are things that should be removed. Now, if you close your eyes and look at your mind, wondering "what are these signs and features in my mind?" almost all of them, devotees, the signs and features in the mind of the majority of people are associated with the unwholesomeness. They are "beautiful signs" (subha-nimitta). With those beautiful signs, it is greed that grows. Also, there are many perceptions of irritation (paṭigha-saññā). With those perceptions of irritation, it is hatred that grows. So, in this way we see; now look, in our lives, if we can exclude this mentioned unwholesome sign from the mind, if we can identify the unwholesome sign, from that point forward there is no way for this unwholesome anger to grow or for unwholesome bodily action to persist, devotees.

So, because of that, our minds are filled with unwholesome signs like this. As it is mentioned in the Dhamma, devotees, at the moment of death, there are three—Kamma, Kamma-nimitta, and Gati-nimitta—and it is said that one of them becomes the object of our mind. Now, at that moment, what we call these Kamma-nimitta are those perceptions created, gathered, and collected in the mind.

Where will you be born?

Now look, devotees, in the life we spend from morning until night, if we die at some moment, what will happen to us? Where will we go and be born? How many times a day in our mind do we remember The Fortunate Lord Buddha? Do we remember mother and father with compassion and loving-kindness? Devotees, those who live in our own home could be mother, father, or siblings—even with these people we have clashed and have ill-will and anger. Then all those perceptions are also associated with the

unwholesomeness, associated with irritation, devotees. Even if you take the country like this, or take the world, or think and contemplate in various fields—look there, it is anger that is born for us. In all those places, what has been gathered are some perceptions of irritation. What exists in our mind are some clashing perceptions. Some perceptions rooted in clashing. So, when directing the mind again and again to those very perceptions, rooted in that clashing, that very perception of irritation becomes powerful and begins to grow in our mind.

Now, is this something that should be developed? Is the perception of irritation, is ill-will (vyāpāda) something that should be developed? But without knowing, what we have developed in our mind are these perceptions of irritation. What we have developed is hatred. So because of that, devotees, we should not keep these things in the mind. Why keep them? These few perceptions of irritation. These perceptions of unwholesomeness. So, they are which should be removed; but then, these are what have been collected. Perceptions that should be removed have been collected. In that way, which have been collected are unwholesome. It is unwholesomeness that has been collected. The Fortunate Lord Buddha does not mention in the Dhamma to collect unwholesomeness, does he? Now, we have heard plenty that "unwholesomeness, unwholesome collects," "one collects unwholesomeness," and so on. Now you yourself can look at your mind's side and understand: "Do I have unwholesomeness in my mind? Is it unwholesomeness that has collected in my mind? Are there unwholesome roots in my own mind?" Behold, when seeing like that, if there are unwholesome roots, the relevant mindfulness, wisdom, and labeling to abandon those unwholesome roots must be performed in this way within the Dhamma, devotees.

Then there is no way to incline toward the wholesomeness

So, because of that, we will teach in the future about sense-restraint and so on. How do these signs and features come into the mind? How to avoid these? How should we act in these places? So, because of that, if we are not careful within this Dhamma, devotees, every moment we reflect, with every intention that is born in our mind, what we think, contemplate, and reflect on are things that burn, scorch, and distress the mind-stream, and also things through which we get angry, and things through which greed, hatred, and delusion grow in our mind. So, because of that, identifying these, one must mark the unwholesome signs in this way.

Also, devotees, from that point forward, wholesome signs. These wholesome signs—now I told you—how many times a day do you remember a given alms-offering? Do you remember a precept you protected? How many wholesomeness, compassionate, and loving-kindness associated perceptions are there in your mind? These things are not in the mind in abundance. Then there is no way for the mind to incline toward the wholesomeness. There is no way for a wholesomeness to grow in the mind.

The person who knows the Dhamma is one who keeps their mind-stream pure in this way

Therefore, you must collect wholesome perceptions. You must direct the mind toward wholesome objects. You must collect those very same wholesome signs and features again and again. Then, these unwholesome signs can be abandoned by conditioning wholesome signs. Greed can be abandoned by arising non-greed. Hatred can be abandoned with the help of non-hatred. Also, delusion can be abandoned by conditioning non-delusion. So, because of that, now in places where you give alms, well-direct the mind to that relevant bodily action and that object, and in those places, you must take those signs and features. Now you go to the Bodhi-terrace, go near

the Bodhi tree. After that, you go near the Stupa. You go to great Stupa-worshiping great merit-ceremonies. Now, you must see how much you can arise and remember those relevant perceptions again and again within your mind-stream.

When arising and labeling on those perceptions, you must identify how much the mind becomes free. How much a wholesomeness, an ease, is created in the mind. How much the mind becomes pure. How much the mind becomes restrained. How much the mind becomes tamed. Behold, to protect the restraint and purity of the mind in your life like that, you must act to identify the objects and let those signs and features grow again and again within the mind, devotees. So, look, because we do not know this Dhamma—within the knowing of this Dhamma—because of the not-knowing of the Dhamma, then how many wrongs and shortcomings happen by our hand? Then, the person who knows the Dhamma, devotees, is one who keeps their mind-stream pure in this way.

You should not collect unwholesome signs

Now then, when seeing a person, we will also be able to read that person's mind. When seeing a person, is that person with a wholesome mind? Is they with an unwholesome mind? What is that person thinking and contemplating?—that can also be seen through the way that person acts. Also, one can identify for oneself how pure one's mind is. How restrained it is. One can identify for oneself whether one's mind is tamed. Devotees, one receives the ability to identify in this way: "how big a capability, how big a skill have I developed and practiced within this Buddha-Dispensation by this time?" Therefore, devotees, you must well-understand the matter of identifying unwholesome signs and identifying wholesome signs. You should not collect unwholesome signs. You should not let unwholesome roots grow. You should not let unwholesome bodily actions, verbal actions, and mental actions grow. You must collect wholesome perceptions. Also, you

must develop wholesome roots: non-greed, non-hatred, and non-delusion. You must develop wholesome bodily actions, verbal actions, and mental actions. We intend to mention in this sermon that you should create this transformation in your life by this time.

So, be skillful to identify in this way the unwholesome perception that affects the unwholesomeness, that is the condition for the unwholesomeness, and that is the condition for unwholesome bodily, verbal, and mental action. Identifying it, direct the mind and establish mindfulness while labeling on that unwholesome perception, that unwholesome sign, in this way. Also, identify the wholesome signs that are the root for the wholesome, for the wholesome roots, and for the wholesome bodily, verbal, and mental actions; identifying them, we advise these devotees in this sermon to maintain them by establishing mindfulness while directing the mind to those wholesome signs again and again and again, and practicing and training those very same wholesome perceptions again and again.

May The Triple Gems be the refuge for all these devotees!

So, in the next sermon, we intend to preach about Buddhānussati (recollection of qualities of the Lord Buddha) meditation, about a recollection (Anussati) meditation, relevant to this very same thing. So, relevant to that Buddhānussati and other recollection meditations, relevant to going on practicing those recollection meditations, I give the advice and instruction to act further by directing the mind to them, and by practicing, training, and creating in this way the mental background and the mind to identify those objects—and I wish that the strength, the courage, the fortune, and the opportunity needed for that may be received by all these devotees through the merit of having heard this Dhamma! I conclude the sermon by wishing that the merit of having heard this Dhamma may also cause all these devotees to realize the sublime Four Noble Truths and be comforted by the Great Supreme Nibbāna! May it be a fortune!
May The Triple Gems be the refuge for all these devotees!

- Oghatharana Mārgaya (The Path of Crossing the Torrent)
- Sermon No. 11
- Buddhānussati Meditation

Namo tassa bhagavato arahato sammā sambuddhassa!
Namo tassa bhagavato arahato sammā sambuddhassa!
Namo tassa bhagavato arahato sammā sambuddhassa!

I pay homage to that Fortunate One, the Worthy One, the Perfectly Self-enlightened One! May my homage be offered!

So, today is the eleventh sermon of this series

Compassionate Buddhist devotees, endowed with faith and wisdom, who listen to the Dhamma through this Oghatarana Daham Sangrahaya YouTube Channel, these devotees are preparing today to join us with yet another Dhamma sermon. Everyone is preparing to connect with the eleventh sermon referring to the sequence that we are conducting today as well.

An Answer to All Your Questions Has Already Been Received in Life

By now, for these devotees, we have completed ten Dhamma sermons in order, purely, to the best of our strength. Through those ten Dhamma sermons, we have presented to these devotees, in order: the way to train within this Buddha Sāsana, the way to identify the unwholesomeness, the way to identify the wholesomeness, the way to identify unwholesome roots, the way to identify wholesome roots, and also the way to identify unwholesome-related bodily actions, verbal actions, and mental actions, the way to identify wholesome-related bodily actions, verbal actions, and mental actions, as well as the way to identify unwholesome signs and wholesome signs through this sermon series by now.

So, devotees, when these devotees meet with us, you mention to us, "Venerable Bante, we cannot remove the anger that is in our minds. Likewise, we cannot remove the greed that is in the mind. Also, we cannot remove these unwholesome signs. Similarly, we cannot remove these unwholesome-related bodily actions, verbal actions, and mental actions." But devotees, an answer to all those questions of yours has been received in life by now.

A Problem Many Have is Getting Angry Very Quickly

A problem many people have is that they get angry very quickly. Most people do not know how this anger arises or how we can remove this anger. Similarly, many people want to forget events that happened in the past in their lives. No matter how much they try to forget past events, that group of events repeatedly emerge within their minds, and start reminding them and making them recollect those unpleasant experiences. They start reminding and making them recollect those unpleasant events. When these unpleasant experiences and unpleasant events are reminded, when the mind-stream inclines toward them, because of the distress that arises therein, many people seek strategies to prevent those things from being remembered.

They turn to wrong paths and make the problem even more complex. They even destroy their entire lives. Devotees, that is not necessary; The Fortunate Lord Buddha, has well-preached this Dhamma to us. You only have to listen a little.

Devotees, now, through our previous program, where we identified unwholesome signs and wholesome signs, regarding those unwholesome signs: how to forget those events we dislike remembering from our past, how to let go of them, and how to let go of the way they repeatedly emerge within the mind was mentioned in that sermon.

So, along with those unwholesome signs and those unwholesome perceptions, the anger, irritation, resentment, fear, sadness, and displeasure that were in our minds also leave. Right when those unwholesome perceptions are removed, that resentment we mentioned before is removed from our mind. Hatred is removed from our mind. Similarly, sadness is removed from our mind. Displeasure is removed from our mind. Fear is removed from our mind. That pain in the mind is removed. So, if we are to remove these mentioned things without letting them arise again and again in our mind in this way, you must perform the exercises we mentioned in the previous sermons. As you engage and engage in those exercises, devotees, you will understand that it is not such a difficult matter.

There is No Way for Delusion to Function in Our Mind

As soon as you properly direct the mind toward those unwholesome signs and label on those unwholesome signs as "unwholesome signs", those unwholesome signs, devotees, just like an ice cube melts when placed in the sun, instead of emerging again and again within your mind-stream, they hide away from within your own mind-stream. They are let go. They cease. They vanish.

Now, what have you wanted all this time? To forget these unwholesome signs, those events, and those experiences. Then, it happens very easily in the Dhamma right when the mind is directed to that object and mindfulness is established. You identify the method of identifying and removing those signs (nimitta) and features (anunimitta) from within your mind-stream in that way.

So look, devotees, when we practice and train in this way within this Dhamma, we can discard all those things we dislike from our mind-stream. We can remove, discard, and cease from our mind the things that burn,

scorch, defile, distress, weary, and bring suffering to our mind-stream. So, if such unwholesome perceptions do not arise in our mind, then devotees, there is no way for greed to function in our mind. There is no way for hatred to function in our mind. Likewise, there is no way for delusion to function in our mind.

Devotees, also, the mind becomes cleaner and cleaner, but the mind does not become unclean. As long as you do not engage in these exercises and perform those labeling and establishments of mindfulness in this way, the mind will not be cleaned. The mind becomes more and more unclean. Agitation, fear, trepidation, sorrow, weeping, and lamentation arise in the mind more and more. Devotees, therefore, by doing those exercises and identifying unwholesome signs in that way, all the painful feelings that were associated with those unwholesome signs are removed in that way. Unwholesome perceptions are also removed.

Likewise, those mentioned unwholesome roots—the unwholesome roots called greed, hatred, and delusion—are also removed. Along with that, the unwholesome-related bodily actions, verbal actions, and mental actions are also removed. This experience must now be within you as you practice this Dhamma. Also, this abiding must be within you in that way. Similarly, this exertion relevant to removing this unwholesome must arise within you. Through such exertion, by now, a state of identifying those unwholesome mental conditions and acting properly must be constantly arising within yourself, devotees.

One Becomes Able to See According to One's Own Wisdom

Similarly, next, we mentioned that you should collect and gather more wholesome signs, you should incline the mind toward those wholesome signs, and having inclined the mind toward those wholesome signs and directed the mind to those objects, you should establish mindfulness. Then, while

performing that wholesome nature, having removed all the mistakes, shortcomings, and unclearnesses, if there was any mental defect associated with those wholesome perceptions, having removed that defect, and while talking with those wholesome signs, if there was some defect in our mind, having removed that defect, and while acting with those wholesome signs, if there was a shortcoming in our bodily actions, having removed those, and by further directing the mind through those wholesome signs and cultivating the wholesome roots called non-greed, non-hatred, and non-delusion, along with those cultivated wholesome roots, having further purified bodily actions, verbal actions, and mental actions, the ability, wisdom, mindfulness, and stillness to develop the wholesomeness within the skillfulness will start arising within you, devotees.

So, those matters we explained to you in that way. Also, we repeatedly mentioned to these devotees in all the previous ten sermons that one must act accordingly. These facts and matters we mentioned to you little by little. But by now, many facts and matters have gathered within ten sermons. Also, a great journey has been traveled in order in this way. Within that journey, you have correctly identified the removal of defilements. It is also seen that you have received a great relief within that removal of defilements. An understanding about the journey toward the Noble Eightfold Path within the Dhamma is also starting to arise now, little by little.

So, you realize for yourself that you are not where you were yesterday today. Why? Day by day, as this wholesomeness grows and grows, it leads you further and further through that Dhamma, step by step. You are able to see for yourself, through yourself, according to your own wisdom, the nature of traveling deeper and deeper into this Dhamma, step by step.

One Must Be Skillful to Act Without Letting One's Mind Wander

Therefore, devotees, having taught the Dhamma to these devotees up to the point of identifying those wholesome signs and unwholesome signs in that way, we said that this topic of identifying unwholesome signs and wholesome signs cannot be finished in a day or two, or in a program or two. We need to tell many facts and matters here. There are ten anussati (recollection) meditation subjects. We said we must teach you several of those ten anussati meditation subjects. Also, we said that the entry of these unwholesome signs and wholesome signs to the mind, regarding the sense non-restraint and sense restraint, must be taught here. Therefore, this topic is very important to us, devotees, to further identify our wholesome perceptions and develop those wholesome mental actions we perform from here onwards in the path of Dhamma. Also, these wholesome perceptions are important to develop wholesome verbal actions. Similarly, those wholesome perceptions are important to develop wholesome bodily actions.

Furthermore, not only that, those wholesome perceptions are important to remove from the mind, to erase, and to get rid of the opportunity for unwholesome signs to arise. Because it is only if those unwholesome signs arise that unwholesome-related bodily actions, verbal actions, mental actions, and unwholesome roots arise. Therefore, one must identify these wholesome signs well and develop the wholesome signs. Also, having identified the unwholesome signs, from here onwards, these devotees must be able to see the unwholesome sign exactly as an unwholesome sign and let go of it. Without getting attached to that unwholesome sign, without clashing with that unwholesome sign, without being deluded by that unwholesome sign, and by acting without getting attached, clashing, or being deluded while identifying that unwholesome sign, one must be skillful to act without letting one's mind wander through unwholesome-related bodily actions, verbal actions, and mental actions again.

To Direct the Mind to the Four Foundations of Mindfulness and See the Three Marks of Existence

So, for all of that, identifying these unwholesome perceptions, identifying wholesome perceptions, and developing wholesome-related perceptions is important. Actually, devotees, within this Buddha Sāsana, if we think even up to Arahatship, what is to be done is identifying these perceptions such as the perception of impermanence (anicca saññā), the perception of non-self (anatta saññā), the perception of suffering (dukkha saññā), the perception of abandonment (pahāna saññā), the perception of disadvantages (ādīnava saññā), the perception of foulness (asubha saññā), and while directing the mind to those perceptions, developing mindfulness, stillness, and wisdom with those perceptions.

Therefore, devotees, from here onwards, when we practice and train in these exercises properly, in the future, we will very rapidly be able to direct the mind to the Four Foundations of Mindfulness and see these three marks of existence called impermanence, suffering, and non-self in the aggregates, elements, and sense bases. Now, the mental state that creates that ability, that skill, is what is formed in your mind-stream when acting in this way. What we are doing through these sermons is developing and maintaining the spiritual faculties called faith, energy, mindfulness, stillness, and wisdom relevant to that. So, that ability will arise within you day by day as you practice and train in this Dhamma.

How Long Did it Take for Venerable Devadatta to Let Go of Anger from the Mind?

So, devotees, today we are preaching to you how to identify a wholesome sign clearly and purely, and how to perform an anussati meditation further with that wholesome sign. That is why we expect here today to preach the Buddhānussati (Recollection of the Buddha) meditation to you.

So then, we know now that the primary thing, the condition for anger to grow in our mind, is that perception of resistance. It is based on the unwise attention (ayoniso manasikāra) performed with that perception of resistance that anger, resentment, and sadness—these mentioned things—grow in our mind. Then, what is fundamental to that is that relevant perception of resistance; it could be a perception of a person, regarding a person, or else it could be a perception relevant to some object or thing. By the mind being directed to this perception continuously, along with that unwise attention performed, malice (vyāpāda) arises again and again in one's mind. So why did it arise like that? We are used to them. We have plenty of experiences in our lives of having developed the unwholesomeness with an unwholesome perception, rather than developing the wholesomeness with a wholesome perception in our mind.

Therefore, in that way, when an unwholesome perception comes into our mind and we repeatedly direct the mind to it and grow anger within unwise attention, our mind identifies that perception well. That perception becomes well-manifested in our mind. Along with that, devotees, an unwholesome state that we cannot let go of from our mind is prepared. See that—how long did it take for Venerable Devadatta to let go of anger from his mind? Look, devotees, for how long he carried that anger. Even up to the point where the Buddha attained Enlightenment, Venerable Devadatta carried that anger; it was only at the final moment that he let go. It took many eons.

So, did you think, did you reflect for a moment, devotees, that such a perception of irritation arising in our mind is carried not only in this life but also to next, next lives, and by creating the opportunity for unwholesome roots to be born, it becomes a condition for unwholesome-related bodily actions, verbal actions, and mental actions to arise? Therefore, an unwholesome sign arising in our mind is not only a condition

for the unwholesomeness in the future in that way, but also in the future, it creates the path for us to be born in the four woeful realms. Devotees, therefore, an unwholesome sign arising in our mind is this dangerous. But devotees, if we have not performed such an identification or a reading in life, if we have not created a mindfulness and wisdom that we must identify and remove unwholesome perceptions, or if we have not prepared a method, a methodology, or a path, you should identify while practicing this Dhamma that instead of having obtained a refuge and help within this Dhamma, a strange helplessness and an insecurity still exists within us.

Recollection of the Qualities of the Buddha Repeatedly is Called Buddhānussati Meditation

Then, devotees, let us first define what this Buddhānussati meditation is. Recollection of the qualities of the Buddha repeatedly is called Buddhānussati meditation.

If we are to recollect those Buddha-qualities repeatedly, here, forming this perception of the Buddha (Buddha saññā), the sign (nimitta) called the Buddha, and making it an object for our mind becomes important. Otherwise, even if we recollect Buddha-qualities like "The Buddha did not commit sin even in secret," without bringing up the sign to the mind and without directing the mind continuously to that object, we will be unable to reflect on the Buddha's qualities repeatedly. there is no way for our mind to be properly established in the quality, because the relevant sign is not in our mind. There is no place for the mind to be directed repeatedly because that perception has not been produced in our mind. Then, devotees, we must first make that perception of the person, that perception of the Buddha, properly make it object for our mind. So, the way we perform that matter is what is important.

So, devotees, if we are to make that Buddha-perception well-manifest to the mind, to bring it up, what should be done? First, you should go in front of that Buddha statue in the shrine room of your home and, devotees, you should stay looking well at that Lord Buddha. In that way, having directed your eye well toward the Lord Buddha, you stay looking at the Lord Buddha. Then, what you should practice here is nothing else.

First, devotees, having directed the eye toward the Buddha and directed the mind without letting the mind go to another object, you should develop the ability to stay. Then, the ability to keep your eye directed toward that Buddha image for a long time. When you go before the Lord Buddha like this and keep your eye directed toward that Buddha image, within a very short time, your mind might be directed to another sound you hear, or it might be directed to something done or said in the past.

When it is directed like that, next, you yourself see and identify, "Now, the mind that was directed to the image of the Lord Buddha through my eye, having let go of that Buddha image, has now been directed to a sound." Or "Now it has traveled through something, an event, that happened in the past." Or "It has directed to a pain in the body." Okay, having identified that, devotees, again once more, having known that and identified that, you direct your eye toward the Lord Buddha and direct the mind. Stay looking at the Lord Buddha. Now, devotees, bit by bit, bit by bit, you become able to stay looking at the Lord Buddha, toward the Lord Buddha in this way, without the mind being directed anywhere else.

Having looked well at the Lord Buddha like this, you now stay looking at the Lord Buddha's head, forehead, and then the eyes, nose, lips, cheeks, chin, neck, shoulders, hands, chest, and also the sacred feet, in a way from top to bottom, now directing the eye toward the Lord Buddha and looking at that image of the Lord Buddha again and again, again and again. Devotees, having acted like this, you close your eyes well for a few minutes. Now,

having closed your eyes well, what is necessary is to make the way the Lord Buddha is residing an object for the mind. It should be possible to understand in the mind, to recollect, and to see as if seen by the eye. Devotees, now, not with the eye, but see the Lord Buddha with the mind; now you try to direct your mind toward the statue in front of you and identify the way that statue is residing. Having closed your eyes, you repeatedly direct the mind toward the Lord Buddha.

Now, devotees, we should understand: if it is a reclining statue in front of us, then that perception, that sign of the way the Lord Buddha is reclining, should become an object for our mind. Similarly, if the Lord Buddha is residing in the full-lotus posture, then that object of the Lord Buddha sitting, the sign of that perception, should be well-objectified to our mind. Devotees, otherwise, a feature (anunimitta) such as the Lord Buddha's head, the forehead area, then the eyes, nose, lips, cheeks, etc., should at least be well-perceived by your mind. Devotees, in this way, you must repeatedly close your eyes and try to make that Buddha-perception manifest to your mind.

If you cannot, once more you open your eyes and stay looking at the Lord Buddha. As mentioned, from the head down to the feet, looking and looking, you go without haste, as signs and features. After that, once more, these devotees close their eyes and directs the mind toward that Lord Buddha. Then, while performing that several times, devotees, the way the Lord Buddha is residing becomes manifest to the mind of these devotees. The Buddha-perception becomes an object for your mind. The way the Lord Buddha is residing becomes an object for your mind. After becoming an object like this, directing the mind again and again to that very sign, that very object, you start to recollect the qualities of the Lord Buddha such as Araham. "The Buddha did not commit sin even in secret," and so on. In that way, you start to recollect a Buddha-quality that you know, that you like, and that your mind is most fond of, while repeatedly directing the mind to

that sign. This way of repeatedly directing the mind - **anussati** and performing recollection with that Buddha-perception and that sign is called Buddhānussati meditation.

One Can Develop This Buddhānussati Meditation Even Up to the Noble Eightfold Path

Devotees, when the Buddha-perception becomes an object for our mind repeatedly and becomes manifest with such an anussati meditation, at every moment you can, at any moment you close your eyes for a moment, you become able to produce that Buddha-perception in the mind. Now, if I tell these devotees to recollect the clock on the wall at your home, it doesn't take much time; it is remembered and recollected instantly. It is just like that.

Devotees, when one practices an anussati meditation such as Buddhānussati in that way, he or she can maintain mindfulness while standing, sitting, walking, or at any posture, at any moment, by manifesting this Buddha-perception and repeatedly recollecting the Buddha-qualities. We have met practitioners as well as monks who engage in Buddhānussati meditation in this way for the greater part of the day, devotees. They can produce the Buddha-perception in the mind at any moment.

Now, at any moment, when those unwholesome-related signs and unwholesome-related perceptions come, you can remove those unwholesome-related perceptions and signs at any moment by making the Buddha-perception you practiced, trained, and produced the basis, and making Buddhānussati the basis, devotees. Likewise, mindfulness, stillness, and wisdom start to grow well with that sign. So, practice this Buddhānussati meditation, devotees. This can go very deep. From Buddhānussati meditation, one can also direct the mind toward the direction of reflection on the elements. From Buddhānussati meditation,

even by bringing up signs such as kasina, and by meditating through kasina signs and producing that mind up to the fourth absorption (jhāna), this Buddhānussati meditation itself helps and assists in producing jhāna and higher knowledge (abhiññā). Similarly, through the meditation on the reflection on the elements, the procedure that grows up to the Noble Eightfold Path can be developed in that way through this Buddhānussati meditation. Also, devotees, you can remove any unwholesome state that comes to the mind in any way, by making this Buddhānussati meditation the basis, Devotees. Therefore, when you practice this Buddhānussati recollection in your life in that way, you understand it, devotees.

When it becomes well-manifest to your mind again and again, you realize that for a long time, those unwholesome signs, perceptions of resistance, and sensual perceptions do not enter your mind. Now, those things we tried to discard, which we recollected and removed, do not arise in your mind for a long time. Practitioners who repeatedly perform anussati meditations tell us, "Venerable Sir, for many days such a perception of resistance did not arise in my mind. A sensual perception did not arise in my mind. As you said, this Buddha-perception, wholesome perception, and wholesome-related bodily actions, verbal actions, and mental actions arose in my mind, and this anussati meditation started to grow."

The Teacher Preached This While Residing in Veluvanārāma, Making the Son of Dārusākatika the Occasion

I will present to you here a verse and its commentary story from the 21st Prakiṇṇaka Vagga of the Dhammapada:

Suppabuddhaṃ pabujjhanti - sadā gotamasāvakā
Yesaṃ divā ca ratto ca - niccaṃ buddhagatā sati

Those disciples of Gotama whose mindfulness is constantly fixed on the qualities of the Buddha, both by day and by night, always awaken happily. (They sleep well and wake up well, considering the qualities of the Buddha).

The Story of the Son of Dāru sākatika (Wood-cutter) (Dhammapada Commentary)

The Lord Buddha preached this Dhamma sermon, "**Suppabuddhaṃ**," while residing in Veluvanārāma, based on the son of Dāru sākatika.

In the city of Rajagaha, two boys, known as the son of the one with right view and the son of the one with wrong view, were constantly playing ball. Between these two, the son with right view, when throwing the ball, would recollect Buddhānussati and say "**Namo Buddhassa**" before throwing the ball. The other boy, for the quality of the heretics (tīrthaka), would say "**Namo Arahantānaṃ**" (Homage to the Arahants) and throw the ball. Between the two of them, the son of the one with right view wins—the other loses. Seeing his action, the other boy thought, "This person throws the ball while recollecting this and saying this, and he defeats me. I shall do the same," and he practiced **Buddhānussati**.

Thereafter, one day, his father, having yoked the cart, was going for wood; he took this child along, filled the wood-cart in the forest, and while returning, near a cemetery outside the city where water was convenient, he unyoked the oxen and took food. Thereafter, those oxen entered the city in the evening along with the other herd of cattle as usual. The carter also chased the oxen and entered the city, but by the time he saw the oxen in the evening and was about to leave with them, the city gate was closed.

Then, since the carter could not go out of the city, his son slept alone under the cart at night. In the city of Rajagaha, non-humans are naturally abundant. Two non-humans saw him sleeping near the cemetery. One, being

of wrong view, was opposed to the Sāsana. One, being of right view, was in favor of the Sāsana. From them, the one with wrong view said, "We have eaten nothing; let us eat him." The other said, "It is useless; I do not like it," and prevented it. Even though he was prevented by the other, disregarding his word, he pulled the child by the foot. Because the child had practiced **Buddhānussati**, he immediately said "**Namo Buddhassa**." The non-human became greatly frightened and stood aside.

Subsequently, the other said, "We have done something that should not have been done. Let us perform a punishment compensation," and they stayed guarding him. The one with wrong view entered the city, filled a food vessel from the King's dining vessels, and brought it. Thereafter, both of them, acting as his parents, attended to him and fed him, and declared the news, "Let the King see these letters, let no one else see them," and by the power of the demon, they inscribed letters on the food vessel, placed the bowl in the wood-cart, and went after guarding it the whole night.

On the second day, while shouting that item had been stolen from the royal palace, they closed the gates and looked, but not seeing it there, they left the city and looked here and there, and saw the golden vessel in the wood-cart; they took the child saying "This is the thief" and showed him to the King. The King looked at the letters and asked, "What is this, child?" "Your Majesty, I do not know. My parents came at night, fed me, and were guarding me. I slept without fear under the protection of my parents. I only know this much." At this time, his parents also arrived there. The King, knowing that news, took all three of them to the Buddha, told everything, and asked, "Venerable Sir, what is Buddhānussati? Does this happen like this? Or does it happen through Dhammānussati?" Subsequently, the Lord Buddha said, "Great King, not only through pure Buddhānussati, but those who have well-developed the accompanying mind are protected; there is no need for others' protection or mantras or medicines, etc.," and showed six places while saying this verse.

Day and night, every day - if one commemorates the Buddha's qualities
With a state free from fear - one sleeps and awakens happily.

Those disciples of Gotama whose mindfulness is born having the meditation on Buddha-qualities as an object both by night and by day, always sleep and awaken happily. The six things are: constantly having **Buddhagatasati** (mindfulness gone to the Buddha) arise, **Dhammagatasati** arise, **Sanghagatasati** arise, **Kāyagatasati** arise, abstaining from killing beings, and developing loving-kindness by having a compassionate mind arise.

Therein, "**Suppabuddhaṃ pabujjhanti**" means those who sleep taking Buddhagatasati, when they wake up, they wake up well taking Buddhagatasati. "**Sadā gotamasāvakā**"—one who listens to, believes in, and likewise follows the instructions of the Buddha of the Gotama clan is called a Gotama disciple. "**Buddhagatā sati**" is the mindfulness that arises concerning the qualities of the Buddha through the divisions of "**Itipi so bhagavā...**" etc. It exists at all times. The meaning is that they always wake up well. Those who cannot do so, if they recollect Buddhānussati at one of the three times, or two times, or one time in a day, they wake up happily.

At the end of the sermon, the parents along with that child were established in the fruit of Stream-entry. Later, having ordained, they all reached Arahatship. The sermon was successful for those who arrived as well.

Entering Buddhānussati Meditation in Five Steps

Therefore, devotees, we taught you today the way to start Buddhānussati meditation as an anussati meditation, the way to practice and train in it today in that way.

1. As the first step, you must go before the image or statue of the Lord Buddha.
2. As the second step, you must direct your eyes toward the Lord Buddha again.
3. As the third step, you must investigate the Lord Buddha from the crown of the head to the end of the feet, from top to bottom and from bottom to top.
4. As the fourth step, having closed your eyes, you must produce the way the Lord Buddha is residing, that Buddha-perception.
5. As the fifth step, having produced that Buddha-perception, you must start to recollect the qualities of the Lord Buddha while directing the mind to that very Buddha-perception again and again.

So, devotees, in that way, we preached to these devotees today the way to recollect the qualities of the Lord Buddha again and again through Buddhānussati meditation.

May the Triple Gem be the refuge for all these devotees!

So, practice and train in that anussati meditation in that manner. Then we have ten anussati meditations up to Ānāpānasati meditation, called: Dhammānussati meditation, Sanghānussati meditation, Sīlānussati meditation, Cāgānussati meditation, Devatānussati meditation, Upasamānussati meditation, Maraṇānussati meditation, Kāyagatāsati meditation, and Ānāpānasati meditation. We will teach you several of those in the future.

When they are taught, by listening well to those points and practicing and training in that way, devotees, all those unwholesome perceptions that were in your mind will be discarded, and your mind will start to fill with wholesome perceptions. To say the mind is filled with wholesome perceptions means

the mind is filled with wholesome roots. Also, the mind is filled with a wholesome nature. The mind is filled with wholesome-related bodily actions, verbal actions, and mental actions. So, in that way, we will teach you further, in order, the way to be discarded from the unwholesomeness and nourish one's mind within the wholesomeness, and the order of nourishing the mind with the Dhamma. So, today, by now, we have traveled up to Buddhānussati meditation. The topic we are talking about is identifying unwholesome signs and wholesome signs.

It is under that that we taught the Buddhānussati meditation. In future sermons, we will teach several anussati meditations consecutively. We will teach about sense restraint. So, practice those Dhamma-realities; these devotees should practice and train in Buddhānussati meditation in this way, and also, while reminding you to constantly practice and train in the facts and matters that were preached in the previous sermons, may the strength, courage, fortune, path, and opportunity required for that be received by all these devotees through the merit of listening to the Dhamma! May the merit of listening to the Dhamma lead to the realization of the supreme Four Noble Truths and to being comforted by the Great Deathless Peace of Nibbāna! May it be a fortune! Thus, I conclude this sermon here.
May the Triple Gem be the refuge for all these devotees!

Andhabhūtō ayaṃ lōkō
Tanuke'ttha vipassati
Sakuntō jālamuttō'va
Appō saggāya gacchati

This world is blinded.
Only a few here see with insight.
Like a bird escaping from a net,
only a few go to a happy destination or to Nibbāna.

Aggalāva: Preached based on the weaver's daughter
Loka Vagga - Dhammapada